

Thibaut Courtois

BELGIUM

Age 33

Club - Real Madrid

Int. caps - 107

For Thibaut Courtois, the 2026 World Cup finals will be another chapter in a career already defined by experience and distinction. It will be his fourth appearance after 2014, 2018 and 2022. His finest tournament came in Russia in 2018, when Belgium finished third — its best World Cup result — and Courtois won the Golden Glove. The 2026 edition

Qatar 2022 was a tough chapter, with Belgium exiting in the group stage after a 0-0 draw against Croatia — a subdued end for a side built around its golden generation. Since then, Courtois' international path has not been straightforward. He missed Euro 2024

following a fallout with former coach Domenico Tedesco, before returning to the Belgium squad in March 2025 under Rudi Garcia after nearly two years away.

Belgium has since secured qualification for 2026, finishing unbeaten and top of Group J after a 7-0 win over Liechtenstein. At club level, Courtois remains a key figure for Real Madrid.

After missing most of 2023-24 with knee injuries, he returned in time to start the Champions League final, making important saves as Madrid beat Borussia Dortmund 2-0 at Wembley.

This season, he has made 41 appearances [at the time of writing], with 120 saves and 15 clean sheets, underlining his continued value beyond reputation.

